

# Assassination of Zhang Zuolin, 1928

1928 -> Kwantung Army - assassinated Zhang -> attempt to replace him with a new and more co-operative leader.

- Since Zhang was perceived as an ally of the Japanese -> Kwantung army thought it could blame the assassination on the ongoing rivalries among Chinese warlords -> and force the Japanese government to let them take over Manchuria.

However - emperor Criticized the Kwantung Army's actions and demanded that the prime minister discipline them.

- without real authority over Japanese military -> PM was unable to force the military leaders to punish those who were responsible for the assassination.
- this incident revealed how emperor failed to control the military.
- also showed that military could defy the civilian govt.